Team Garden State

LaunchGate

Give Mastercard's own engineers the promise it already makes to customers.

Presented by

Team Garden State

Event

LEAD ASPIRE 2026, Microsoft Times Square

Customer

Mastercard, with EY

The team

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Engagement lead · API, rules and readiness model

Melanie
Product and front end · portal and deployment

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Cloud · Azure Static Web Apps and delivery

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AI · Azure AI Foundry agent, risk memo, Bicep

[Name 5]
[Role]

Where we have worked

[Logo 1]
[Logo 2]
[Logo 3]
[Logo 4]
[Logo 5]
[Logo 6]

Fast for customers. Fast for partners. Slow for its own people.

< 1 second

For customers: to authorize a transaction, billions of times a year.

15 days

For partners: Product Express promises a fintech a live card program, status visible to every party.

6 to 8 months

For its own engineers: 12 handoffs before a team can start building. Reported in Discovery.

Product Express: mastercard.com (15 days after due diligence and contract) · Discovery with Mastercard Business Development, 12 Oct 2026

LaunchGate: one request, governed end to end

Agents prepare. Rules decide. People approve.

Ask once

A business owner or engineer answers a few plain questions. Secure defaults are applied automatically.

Rules decide

A deterministic model scores risk and runs every rule. Each result names the control it cites and the fix.

Agent prepares

An Azure AI Foundry agent drafts the Bicep and a risk memo. Read-only; it never approves.

People approve

Only the approvals that must stay human, in parallel. A GitHub gate blocks deployment until they sign.

Evidence written

Append-only audit trail. The pack a partner bank or auditor asks for already exists.

Today

12 handoffs, 6 to 8 months

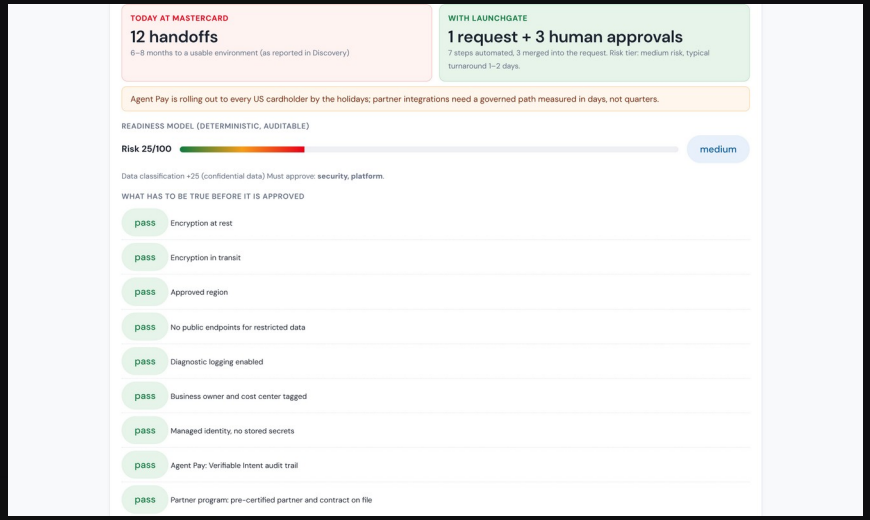
With LaunchGate

1 request + 1 to 2 human approvals

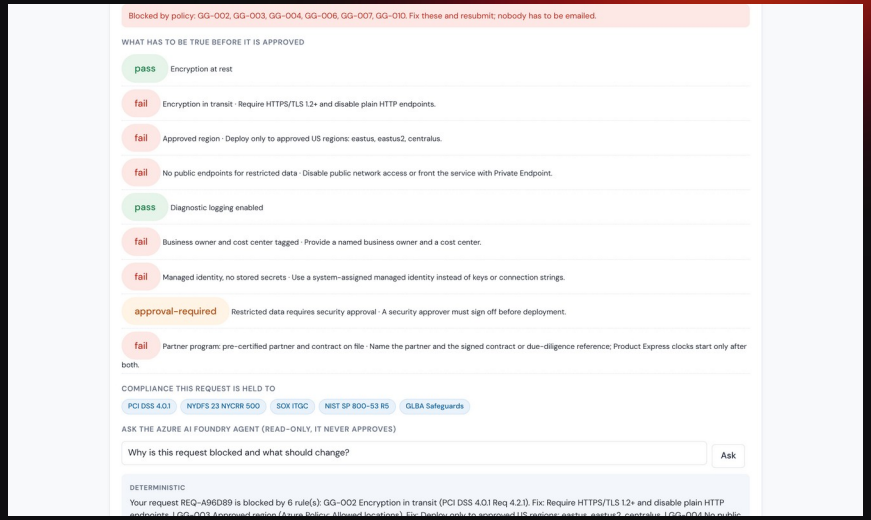
What never changes

Nothing deploys without a person

Governed go-live, in minutes



Business owner view: today versus LaunchGate, risk tier, who must approve, and what has to be true.



Misconfigured program: blocked with the exact rules and controls, and the Foundry agent explains the fix.

Scenarios: fintech card program · Agent Pay airline integration · internal service · misconfigured program

Six steps, all on Microsoft

1 Portal

One plain-language request; secure defaults applied

Static Web Apps · React

2 Rule engine

Deterministic rules pass or fail and name the control

Azure Functions · Azure Policy schema

3 AI agent

Drafts the Bicep and risk memo; explains blocks. Read-only

Azure AI Foundry · open model

4 Approval

Required humans approve in parallel; no self-approval

Microsoft Entra ID roles

5 Deploy gate

Nothing ships until approval is recorded

GitHub Actions environment rule

6 Audit log

Every step, actor and rule, append-only

Azure Cosmos DB

Built with GitHub Copilot

Copilot encoded the rule schema and scaffolded modules; GitHub Actions deploys every change.

Multicloud by design

Rules are cloud-neutral, Defender for Cloud assesses AWS accounts, and deployment sits behind a swappable provider.

Built today on synthetic data. Pilot adds Teams approvals, Defender for Cloud scoring, a Fabric dashboard and real provisioning via Azure Deployment Environments.

An illustrative $6M a year

The model, with inputs labelled

- Reported: 6 to 8 month cycle, ~12 handoffs per request
- Assumed: N programs per year; most of the cycle is waiting, not work
- Value per program = months saved × (partner revenue brought forward + reviewer time + engineer idle time)
- Illustration: 25 programs/yr × 4 months saved = 100 program-months a year
- In dollars (assumed): 5-person team × $150K loaded cost × 4 months idle ≈ $250K per program; × 25 programs ≈ $6M a year
- Benchmark: 58 working days per quarter on compliance audits (Telos)

Time

Months of waiting per program become days. Capital One: 3 months to minutes.

Cost

Repeat reviewer work and idle engineering time removed; evidence written once.

Revenue timing

Partner programs and Agent Pay integrations go live sooner; BD quotes dates it can keep.

Risk

Same answer every time, full audit trail, no process restart on attrition.

The prototype counts handoffs removed and minutes per request so a 90-day pilot can price the real savings. Request volume is the first number a pilot confirms.

Our ask: a 90-day pilot

Days 1 to 30

Load Mastercard's rule catalogue into the schema with the Policy Copilot; security owns the rules.

Days 31 to 60

Entra ID Governance approvals in Teams; GitHub environment gate; Defender for Cloud scoring.

Days 61 to 90

Real provisioning through Azure Deployment Environments; Fabric dashboard reports cycle time per program.



The ask

A sponsor in Business Development and one in Platform Security, one business unit, and the number Discovery could not give us: programs per year. Target in pilot: 12 handoffs to 1 request plus required approvals; readiness from months to days.

Thank you: Microsoft, Mastercard and EY. Team Garden State: Azra Bano, Melanie, Jayden, Adrian, [Name 5]